

WordPress 7 Theme Development Playbook

Complete reference for classic themes, block themes (FSE), Divi 5 child themes, theme.json, WP 7.0 features, testing, and distribution.

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1. Official Documentation Sources

Resource	URL
Theme Handbook	https://developer.wordpress.org/themes/
Block Editor Handbook (Themes)	https://developer.wordpress.org/block-editor/how-to-guides/themes/
theme.json Schema	https://schemas.wp.org/trunk/theme.json
theme.json Schema (GitHub)	https://github.com/WordPress/gutenberg/blob/trunk/schemas/json/theme.json
Theme Review Guidelines	https://developer.wordpress.org/themes/releasing-your-theme/theme-review-guidelines/
WP 7.0 Field Guide	https://make.wordpress.org/core/2026/05/14/wordpress-7-0-field-guide/
WP 7.0 RC3 Announcement	https://wordpress.org/news/2026/05/wordpress-7-0-release-candidate-3/
Divi 5.1 Release Notes	https://www.elegantthemes.com/blog/divi-resources/divi-5-1-release-notes
Theme Unit Test Data	https://codex.wordpress.org/Theme_Unit_Test
Theme Check Plugin	https://wordpress.org/plugins/theme-check/

2. WordPress 7.0 Theme Features

WP 7.0 shipped with **419+ Core Trac tickets**, **76+ enhancements**, and **300+ bug fixes**. Key theme-relevant changes from the [Field Guide](#):

2.1 Modernized Dashboard

- **New admin color scheme and styles** — revamped admin UI
- **View Transitions API in WP Admin** — smooth page transitions
- **Command Palette shortcut** — **Ctrl+K** quick actions
- **Font Library** — built-in font management (install/activate fonts from Google Fonts or upload custom fonts; accessible via theme.json `settings.typography.fontFamilies`)
- **Visual Revisions** — side-by-side visual diff for posts
- **Iframed Editor** — isolated editor rendering for true WYSIWYG
- **Responsive Editing Mode** — preview and edit at different breakpoints directly in the editor
- **Pattern Editing with contentOnly interactivity** — patterns that lock structure but allow content editing

2.2 Design Agility

- **Custom CSS on the block level** — per-block CSS in the block inspector
- **New Headings Block** — unified heading block
- **Breadcrumbs Block** — native breadcrumb navigation block
- **Navigation Block** — enhanced menu creation
- **Video embed cover block** — overlay cover images on embedded videos
- **Gallery block** — improved gallery with lightbox support
- **<p> Block Supports** — paragraph-level design controls
- **Dimensions Support Enhancements** — aspect ratio, min/max height/width

2.3 Developer Toolbox

- **PHP-Only Block Registration** — register blocks server-side without JS build step
- **Interactivity API** — framework for interactive front-end blocks

- **DataViews and DataForms** — new admin data presentation APIs
- **HTML Processing API (HTML Tag Processor + HTML API)** — safer HTML manipulation
- **Template Registration API** — register block templates from plugins
- **Block Hooks** — automatically insert blocks into other blocks

2.4 AI Integration

- **WP AI Client** — unified client for AI model access
- **Client-Side Abilities API** — browser-based AI capabilities
- **AI Connectors Screen** — UI for managing AI service connections

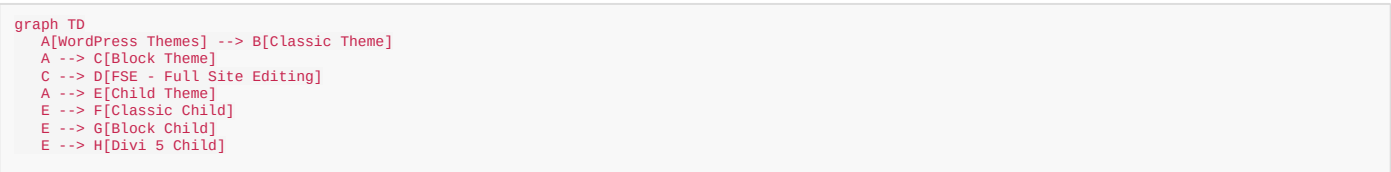
2.5 New Block Supports in WP 7.0

Support	Description
<code>blockVisibility</code>	Hide blocks conditionally per breakpoint
<code>background.backgroundImage</code>	Set background images on any block
<code>background.backgroundSize</code>	Control size, position, repeat
<code>dimensions.aspectRatio</code>	Lock aspect ratios
<code>dimensions.minHeight</code>	Set minimum heights
<code>position.sticky</code>	Sticky positioning
<code>typography.lineHeight</code>	Per-block line height
<code>border</code> (color, radius, style, width)	Full border controls

2.6 Notable: Real-Time Collaboration Deferred

Real-time collaboration was pulled from 7.0 and re-evaluated for 7.1. Theme developers do not need to account for it yet.

3. Theme Types Overview



Type	Template Format	Required Files	FSE Support
Classic Theme	<code>.php</code> templates	<code>style.css</code> + <code>index.php</code>	No (but can use theme.json for block styling)
Block Theme	<code>.html</code> templates in <code>templates/</code> or <code>block-templates/</code>	<code>style.css</code> + <code>templates/index.html</code>	Yes (fully)
Child Theme	Inherits parent; can override	<code>style.css</code> (with <code>Template:</code> header)	Yes (if parent is FSE)
Hybrid	Mix of <code>.php</code> and <code>.html</code>	<code>style.css</code> + <code>index.php</code> + optional <code>templates/index.html</code>	Partial

Quick Identification

- **Classic theme:** `index.php` exists, no `templates/index.html`
- **Block theme:** `templates/index.html` (or `block-templates/index.html`) exists
- **Hybrid:** Both `index.php` and `templates/index.html`

4. Classic Theme Development

4.1 Minimal Classic Theme Structure

my-classic-theme/

■ style.css

■ index.php

■ functions.php

■ header.php

■ footer.php

■ sidebar.php

■ single.php

■ page.php

■ archive.php

■ 404.php

■ search.php

■ screenshot.png

■ assets/

■ css/

■ js/

■ images/

Required – theme header + styles

Required – fallback template

Optional – PHP hooks, theme setup

Site header

Site footer

Sidebar

Single post

Pages

Archive pages

404 error page

Search results

1200×900 preview

4.2 style.css — Theme Header

```

/*
Theme Name: My Classic Theme
Theme URI: https://example.com/my-classic-theme
Author: Your Name
Author URI: https://example.com
Description: A classic WordPress theme for WP 7.0
Version: 1.0.0
Requires at least: 6.0
Tested up to: 7.0
Requires PHP: 8.0
License: GNU General Public License v2 or later
License URI: https://www.gnu.org/licenses/gpl-2.0.html
Text Domain: my-classic-theme
Tags: blog, two-columns, responsive-layout, custom-header
*/

```

4.3 index.php — Main Loop

```

<?php
/**
 * The main template file
 */
get_header(); ?>

<main id="primary" class="site-main">
    <?php if ( have_posts() ) : ?>
        <?php while ( have_posts() ) : the_post(); ?>
            <article id="post-<?php the_ID(); ?>" <?php post_class(); ?>
                <header class="entry-header">
                    <?php the_title( 'h2 class="entry-title"><a href="' . esc_url( get_permalink() ) . '">', '</a></h2>' ); ?>
                </header>
                <div class="entry-content">
                    <?php the_excerpt(); ?>
                </div>
            </article>
        <?php endwhile; ?>

        <div class="pagination">
            <?php the_posts_pagination(); ?>
        </div>
    <?php else : ?>
        <p><?php esc_html_e( 'No posts found.', 'my-classic-theme' ); ?></p>
    <?php endif; ?>
</main>

<?php get_sidebar(); ?>
<?php get_footer(); ?>

```

4.4 functions.php — Theme Setup

```

<?php
/**
 * Theme functions and definitions
 */

// Theme setup
function my_classic_theme_setup() {
    // Add theme support
    add_theme_support( 'title-tag' );
    add_theme_support( 'post-thumbnails' );
    add_theme_support( 'html5', array(
        'search-form',
        'comment-form',
        'comment-list',
        'gallery',
        'caption',
        'style',
        'script',
    ) );
    add_theme_support( 'custom-logo', array(
        'height' => 100,
        'width' => 400,
        'flex-height' => true,
        'flex-width' => true,
    ) );
    add_theme_support( 'responsive-embeds' );
    add_theme_support( 'align-wide' );

    // Block editor support
    add_theme_support( 'editor-styles' );
    add_theme_support( 'wp-block-styles' );

    // Register navigation menus
    register_nav_menus( array(
        'primary' => esc_html__( 'Primary Menu', 'my-classic-theme' ),
        'footer' => esc_html__( 'Footer Menu', 'my-classic-theme' ),
    ) );

    // Set content width
    if ( ! isset( $content_width ) ) {
        $content_width = 1200;
    }
}
add_action( 'after_setup_theme', 'my_classic_theme_setup' );

// Enqueue scripts and styles
function my_classic_theme_scripts() {
    wp_enqueue_style(
        'my-classic-theme-style',
        get_stylesheet_uri(),
        array(),
        wp_get_theme()->get( 'Version' )
    );

    wp_enqueue_script(
        'my-classic-theme-navigation',
        get_template_directory_uri() . '/assets/js/navigation.js',
        array(),
        wp_get_theme()->get( 'Version' ),
        true
    );
}

```

```
});
}
add_action( 'wp_enqueue_scripts', 'my_classic_theme_scripts' );
```

4.5 header.php

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html <?php language_attributes(); ?>>
<head>
    <meta charset="<?php bloginfo( 'charset' ); ?>">
    <meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1">
    <?php wp_head(); ?>
</head>
<body <?php body_class(); ?>>
<?php wp_body_open(); ?>

<header id="masthead" class="site-header">
    <div class="site-branding">
        <?php the_custom_logo(); ?>
        <h1 class="site-title">
            <a href="<?php echo esc_url( home_url( '/' ) ); ?>">
                <?php bloginfo( 'name' ); ?>
            </a>
        </h1>
    </div>

    <nav id="site-navigation" class="main-navigation">
        <?php
            wp_nav_menu( array(
                'theme_location' => 'primary',
                'menu_id'         => 'primary-menu',
            ) );
        ?>
    </nav>
</header>
```

4.6 Classic Theme with theme.json (Hybrid Approach)

Classic themes CAN use `theme.json` for block editor styling:

```
{
  "version": 2,
  "settings": {
    "color": {
      "palette": [
        { "slug": "primary", "color": "#1a73e8", "name": "Primary" },
        { "slug": "secondary", "color": "#5f6368", "name": "Secondary" },
        { "slug": "dark", "color": "#202124", "name": "Dark" },
        { "slug": "light", "color": "#ffffff", "name": "Light" }
      ]
    },
    "typography": {
      "fontFamilies": [
        {
          "fontFamily": "-apple-system, BlinkMacSystemFont, 'Segoe UI', Roboto, sans-serif",
          "slug": "system",
          "name": "System Font"
        }
      ]
    },
    "layout": {
      "contentSize": "840px",
      "wideSize": "1200px"
    }
  },
  "styles": {
    "color": {
      "text": "#202124",
      "background": "#ffffff"
    },
    "typography": {
      "fontFamily": "var(--wp--preset--font-family--system)"
    }
  }
}
```

5. Block Theme Development (FSE)

5.1 Minimal Block Theme Structure

```
my-block-theme/
├── style.css           # Required – theme header
├── theme.json          # Global settings & styles
├── templates/
│   ├── index.html     # Required – default template
│   └── parts/         # Template parts
│       ├── header.html
│       └── footer.html
├── patterns/          # Block patterns
│   └── hero-section.php
├── styles/            # Style variations
│   └── dark.json
├── functions.php      # Optional – PHP hooks
├── screenshot.png     # 1200×900 preview
└── README.txt         # Required for .org submission
```

5.2 style.css (Block Theme)

```
/*
Theme Name: My Block Theme
Theme URI: https://example.com/my-block-theme
```

```
Author: Your Name
Description: A modern block theme for WordPress 7.0 full site editing.
Requires at least: 6.6
Tested up to: 7.0
Requires PHP: 8.0
Version: 1.0.0
License: GNU General Public License v2 or later
License URI: https://www.gnu.org/licenses/gpl-2.0.html
Text Domain: my-block-theme
*/
```

5.3 templates/index.html — Default Template

```
<!-- wp:template-part {"slug":"header","theme":"my-block-theme"} /-->

<!-- wp:group {"tagName":"main","layout":{"type":"constrained"}} -->
<main class="wp-block-group">
  <!-- wp:query {"queryId":0,"query":{"perPage":10,"pages":0,"offset":0,"postType":"post","order":"desc","orderBy":"date","author":"","search":"","exclude":[],"sticky":"","reset":false}} -->
  <div class="wp-block-query">
    <!-- wp:post-template -->
    <!-- wp:post-title {"level":2,"isLink":true} /-->
    <!-- wp:post-date /-->
    <!-- wp:post-excerpt /-->
    <!-- /wp:post-template -->

    <!-- wp:query-pagination -->
    <!-- wp:query-pagination-previous /-->
    <!-- wp:query-pagination-numbers /-->
    <!-- wp:query-pagination-next /-->
    <!-- /wp:query-pagination -->
  </div>
  <!-- /wp:query -->
</main>
<!-- /wp:group -->

<!-- wp:template-part {"slug":"footer","theme":"my-block-theme"} /-->
```

5.4 parts/header.html

```
<!-- wp:group {"tagName":"header","className":"site-header","layout":{"type":"constrained"}} -->
<header class="wp-block-group site-header">
  <!-- wp:group {"layout":{"type":"flex","justifyContent":"space-between","flexWrap":"wrap"}} -->
  <div class="wp-block-group">
    <!-- wp:site-logo /-->
    <!-- wp:site-title /-->
    <!-- wp:navigation {"ref":4,"layout":{"type":"flex","justifyContent":"left"}} /-->
  </div>
  <!-- /wp:group -->
</header>
<!-- /wp:group -->
```

5.5 parts/footer.html

```
<!-- wp:group {"tagName":"footer","className":"site-footer","layout":{"type":"constrained"}} -->
<footer class="wp-block-group site-footer">
  <!-- wp:paragraph {"align":"center"} -->
  <p class="has-text-align-center">
    © <!-- wp:site-title {"level":0} /--> <?php echo date('Y'); ?>
  </p>
  <!-- /wp:paragraph -->
</footer>
<!-- /wp:group -->
```

5.6 Custom Templates via theme.json

```
{
  "version": 2,
  "customTemplates": [
    {
      "name": "Full Width Page",
      "slug": "full-width",
      "postTypes": ["page"],
      "title": "Full Width"
    },
    {
      "name": "No Header/Footer",
      "slug": "blank",
      "postTypes": ["page", "post"],
      "title": "Blank Canvas"
    }
  ]
}
```

Then create `templates/full-width.html` and `templates/blank.html`.

5.7 Template Parts via theme.json

```
{
  "version": 2,
  "templateParts": [
    {
      "name": "header",
      "title": "Header",
      "area": "header"
    },
    {
      "name": "footer",
      "title": "Footer",
      "area": "footer"
    }
  ]
}
```

```

        "name": "sidebar",
        "title": "Sidebar",
        "area": "uncategorized"
    }
}

```

5.8 Style Variations

Create `styles/dark.json`:

```

{
  "version": 2,
  "title": "Dark Mode",
  "settings": {},
  "styles": {
    "color": {
      "text": "#f0f0f0",
      "background": "#1a1a2e"
    },
    "elements": {
      "link": {
        "color": {
          "text": "#64b5f6"
        }
      },
      "button": {
        "color": {
          "text": "#ffffff",
          "background": "#4a90d9"
        }
      }
    }
  }
}

```

Style variations appear under **Appearance > Editor > Styles > Browse styles**.

5.9 Block Patterns

Create `patterns/hero.php`:

```

<?php
/**
 * Title: Hero Section
 * Slug: my-block-theme/hero-section
 * Categories: featured, header
 * Description: A full-width hero section with heading and CTA
 */
?>
<!-- wp:cover {"url":"<?php echo esc_url( get_template_directory_uri() ); ?>/assets/images/hero-bg.jpg","dimRatio":50,"align":"full"} -->
<div class="wp-block-cover alignfull">
  <span aria-hidden="true" class="wp-block-cover__background has-black-background-color has-background-dim"></span>
  <div class="wp-block-cover__inner-container">
    <!-- wp:heading {"textAlign":"center","level":1} -->
    <h1 class="has-text-align-center">Welcome to My Site</h1>
    <!-- /wp:heading -->
    <!-- wp:buttons {"layout":{"type":"flex","justifyContent":"center"}} -->
    <div class="wp-block-buttons">
      <!-- wp:button {"backgroundColor":"primary","textColor":"white"} -->
      <div class="wp-block-button"><a class="wp-block-button__link has-white-color has-primary-background-color has-text-color has-background">Get Started</a></div>
      <!-- /wp:button -->
    </div>
    <!-- /wp:buttons -->
  </div>
</div>
<!-- /wp:cover -->

```

5.10 functions.php for Block Themes

```

<?php
/**
 * Block theme functions
 */

function my_block_theme_setup() {
    // Register pattern categories
    if ( function_exists( 'register_block_pattern_category' ) ) {
        register_block_pattern_category( 'hero', array( 'label' => __( 'Hero Sections', 'my-block-theme' ) ) );
        register_block_pattern_category( 'cta', array( 'label' => __( 'Call to Action', 'my-block-theme' ) ) );
    }

    // Add block styles
    register_block_style( 'core/button', array(
        'name' => 'outline-hover',
        'label' => __( 'Outline on Hover', 'my-block-theme' ),
    ) );
}
add_action( 'init', 'my_block_theme_setup' );

// Enqueue editor styles
function my_block_theme_editor_styles() {
    add_editor_style( 'editor-style.css' );
}
add_action( 'after_setup_theme', 'my_block_theme_editor_styles' );

```

6. Theme.json Complete Reference

6.1 Top-Level Structure

```
{
  "$schema": "https://schemas.wp.org/trunk/theme.json",
  "version": 2,
  "settings": { },
  "styles": { },
  "customTemplates": [ ],
  "templateParts": [ ],
  "patterns": [ ]
}
```

6.2 settings — Complete Property Map

settings.appearanceTools

```
{
  "settings": {
    "appearanceTools": true
  }
}
```

When **true**, enables ALL of: background (image, size), border (color, radius, style, width), color (link, heading, button, caption), dimensions (aspectRatio, minHeight), position (sticky), spacing (blockGap, margin, padding), typography (lineHeight).

settings.color

```
{
  "settings": {
    "color": {
      "background": true,
      "text": true,
      "link": false,
      "heading": false,
      "button": false,
      "caption": false,
      "custom": true,
      "customGradient": true,
      "customDuotone": true,
      "defaultPalette": true,
      "defaultGradients": true,
      "defaultDuotone": true,
      "palette": [
        {
          "slug": "primary",
          "color": "#007cba",
          "name": "Primary"
        },
        {
          "slug": "secondary",
          "color": "#00669b",
          "name": "Secondary"
        }
      ],
      "gradients": [
        {
          "slug": "primary-to-secondary",
          "gradient": "linear-gradient(135deg, #007cba 0%, #00669b 100%)",
          "name": "Primary to Secondary"
        }
      ],
      "duotone": [
        {
          "slug": "dark-grayscale",
          "colors": ["#000000", "#ffffff"],
          "name": "Dark Grayscale"
        }
      ]
    }
  }
}
```

settings.typography

```
{
  "settings": {
    "typography": {
      "customFontSize": true,
      "dropCap": true,
      "fontStyle": true,
      "fontWeight": true,
      "letterSpacing": true,
      "lineHeight": false,
      "textDecoration": true,
      "textTransform": true,
      "writingMode": false,
      "fontFamilies": [
        {
          "fontFamily": "'Inter', sans-serif",
          "slug": "inter",
          "name": "Inter",
          "fontFace": [
            {
              "fontFamily": "Inter",
              "fontStyle": "normal",
              "fontWeight": "400",
              "src": ["file:../assets/fonts/inter-regular.woff2"]
            },
            {
              "fontFamily": "Inter",
              "fontStyle": "normal",
              "fontWeight": "700",
              "src": ["file:../assets/fonts/inter-bold.woff2"]
            }
          ]
        }
      ],
      "fontSizes": [

```

```

        {
          "slug": "small",
          "name": "Small",
          "size": "0.875rem"
        },
        {
          "slug": "medium",
          "name": "Medium",
          "size": "1rem"
        },
        {
          "slug": "large",
          "name": "Large",
          "size": "1.5rem"
        },
        {
          "slug": "x-large",
          "name": "XL",
          "size": "2.5rem",
          "fluid": {
            "min": "2rem",
            "max": "4rem"
          }
        }
      ]
    }
  }
}

```

settings.layout

```

{
  "settings": {
    "layout": {
      "contentSize": "840px",
      "wideSize": "1200px",
      "allowEditing": true,
      "allowCustomContentAndWideSize": true
    }
  }
}

```

settings.spacing

```

{
  "settings": {
    "spacing": {
      "blockGap": null,
      "margin": true,
      "padding": true,
      "customSpacingSize": true,
      "units": ["px", "em", "rem", "vh", "vw", "%"],
      "spacingScale": {
        "operator": "*",
        "increment": 1.5,
        "steps": 7,
        "mediumStep": 1.5,
        "unit": "rem"
      },
      "spacingSizes": [
        { "slug": "30", "size": "clamp(1.5rem, 5vw, 2rem)", "name": "1" },
        { "slug": "40", "size": "clamp(1.8rem, 1.8rem + ((1vw - 0.48rem) * 2.885), 3rem)", "name": "2" },
        { "slug": "50", "size": "clamp(2.5rem, 8vw, 4.5rem)", "name": "3" }
      ]
    }
  }
}

```

settings.border

```

{
  "settings": {
    "border": {
      "color": true,
      "radius": true,
      "style": true,
      "width": true,
      "radiusSizes": [
        { "slug": "small", "size": "4px", "name": "Small" },
        { "slug": "medium", "size": "8px", "name": "Medium" },
        { "slug": "large", "size": "16px", "name": "Large" }
      ]
    }
  }
}

```

settings.dimensions

```

{
  "settings": {
    "dimensions": {
      "aspectRatio": true,
      "minHeight": true
    }
  }
}

```

settings.shadow

```

{
  "settings": {
    "shadow": {
      "defaultPresets": true,

```

```

    "presets": [
      {
        "slug": "subtle",
        "shadow": "0 1px 3px rgba(0,0,0,0.12), 0 1px 2px rgba(0,0,0,0.24)",
        "name": "Subtle"
      },
      {
        "slug": "medium",
        "shadow": "0 3px 6px rgba(0,0,0,0.16), 0 3px 6px rgba(0,0,0,0.23)",
        "name": "Medium"
      }
    ]
  }
}

```

settings.position

```

{
  "settings": {
    "position": {
      "sticky": true
    }
  }
}

```

settings.lightbox

```

{
  "settings": {
    "lightbox": {
      "enabled": true,
      "allowEditing": true
    }
  }
}

```

settings.background

```

{
  "settings": {
    "background": {
      "backgroundImage": true,
      "backgroundSize": true,
      "gradient": true
    }
  }
}

```

settings.blockVisibility (WP 7.0+)

```

{
  "settings": {
    "blockVisibility": {
      "allowEditing": true
    }
  }
}

```

6.3 styles — Complete Reference

Top-Level Style Properties

```

{
  "styles": {
    "color": {
      "text": "#333333",
      "background": "#ffffff",
      "gradient": "linear-gradient(135deg, #ffffff 0%, #f0f0f0 100%)"
    },
    "typography": {
      "fontFamily": "var(--wp--preset--font-family--inter)",
      "fontSize": "1rem",
      "fontStyle": "normal",
      "fontWeight": "400",
      "letterSpacing": "0",
      "lineHeight": "1.6",
      "textDecoration": "none",
      "textTransform": "none"
    },
    "spacing": {
      "blockGap": "1.5rem",
      "margin": {
        "top": "0",
        "right": "0",
        "bottom": "0",
        "left": "0"
      },
      "padding": {
        "top": "0",
        "right": "0",
        "bottom": "0",
        "left": "0"
      }
    },
    "border": {
      "color": "#cccccc",
      "radius": "4px",
      "style": "solid",
      "width": "1px"
    },
    "dimensions": {

```

```

    "minHeight": "100vh"
  },
  "shadow": "0 2px 4px rgba(0,0,0,0.1)",
  "outline": {
    "color": "#007cba",
    "offset": "2px",
    "style": "solid",
    "width": "1px"
  },
  "background": {
    "backgroundImage": {
      "url": "file:./assets/images/bg.png",
      "source": "file",
      "id": 0
    },
    "backgroundPosition": "center center",
    "backgroundRepeat": "no-repeat",
    "backgroundSize": "cover"
  },
  "css": "body { font-smooth: always; }"
}
}
}

```

styles.elements — Element-Specific Styles

```

{
  "styles": {
    "elements": {
      "link": {
        "color": {
          "text": "#007cba"
        },
        "typography": {
          "textDecoration": "underline"
        },
        ":hover": {
          "color": {
            "text": "#005a87"
          },
          "typography": {
            "textDecoration": "none"
          }
        },
        ":focus": {
          "color": {
            "text": "#005a87"
          }
        },
        ":active": {
          "color": {
            "text": "#003d5c"
          }
        }
      },
      "heading": {
        "color": {
          "text": "#111111",
          "background": "transparent"
        },
        "typography": {
          "fontFamily": "var(--wp--preset--font-family--inter)",
          "fontWeight": "700",
          "lineHeight": "1.3"
        }
      },
      "caption": {
        "color": {
          "text": "#666666"
        },
        "typography": {
          "fontSize": "0.875rem"
        }
      },
      "button": {
        "border": {
          "radius": "4px",
          "width": "0"
        },
        "color": {
          "text": "ffffff",
          "background": "#007cba"
        },
        "typography": {
          "fontWeight": "600",
          "fontSize": "1rem"
        },
        "spacing": {
          "padding": {
            "top": "0.75rem",
            "right": "1.5rem",
            "bottom": "0.75rem",
            "left": "1.5rem"
          }
        },
        ":hover": {
          "color": {
            "text": "ffffff",
            "background": "#005a87"
          }
        }
      }
    }
  }
}
}
}
}

```

Supported elements: `link`, `heading`, `caption`, `button`, `h1` through `h6`.

styles.blocks — Per-Block Styles

```

{
  "styles": {
    "blocks": {
      "core/paragraph": {
        "typography": {
          "lineHeight": "1.8"
        },
        "spacing": {
          "margin": {
            "bottom": "1.25rem"
          }
        }
      },
      "core/heading": {
        "typography": {
          "fontFamily": "var(--wp--preset--font-family--inter)"
        }
      },
      "core/group": {
        "spacing": {
          "padding": {
            "top": "2rem",
            "bottom": "2rem"
          }
        }
      },
      "core/quote": {
        "border": {
          "color": "#007cba",
          "style": "solid",
          "width": "0 0 0 4px"
        },
        "spacing": {
          "padding": {
            "left": "1.5rem"
          }
        }
      },
      "core/code": {
        "color": {
          "text": "#f8f8f2",
          "background": "#282a36"
        },
        "typography": {
          "fontFamily": "monospace",
          "fontSize": "0.9rem"
        }
      },
      "core/separator": {
        "color": {
          "text": "#dddddd"
        },
        "border": {
          "width": "2px"
        }
      }
    }
  }
}

```

6.4 Using CSS `ref()` in theme.json

You can reference other style values:

```

{
  "styles": {
    "color": {
      "text": "#333333",
      "background": "#ffffff"
    },
    "blocks": {
      "core/quote": {
        "border": {
          "color": { "ref": "styles.color.text" }
        }
      }
    }
  }
}

```

6.5 Preset Variable Naming Convention

theme.json presets generate CSS custom properties following this pattern:

Preset Type	CSS Variable Pattern	Example
Color palette	<code>--wp--preset--color--{slug}</code>	<code>--wp--preset--color--primary</code>
Gradient	<code>--wp--preset--gradient--{slug}</code>	<code>--wp--preset--gradient--cool-to-warm</code>
Font family	<code>--wp--preset--font-family--{slug}</code>	<code>--wp--preset--font-family--inter</code>
Font size	<code>--wp--preset--font-size--{slug}</code>	<code>--wp--preset--font-size--large</code>
Spacing	<code>--wp--preset--spacing--{slug}</code>	<code>--wp--preset--spacing--40</code>
Border radius	<code>--wp--preset--border-radius--{slug}</code>	<code>--wp--preset--border-radius--small</code>
Shadow	<code>--wp--preset--shadow--{slug}</code>	<code>--wp--preset--shadow--subtle</code>

Using presets in style.css:

```

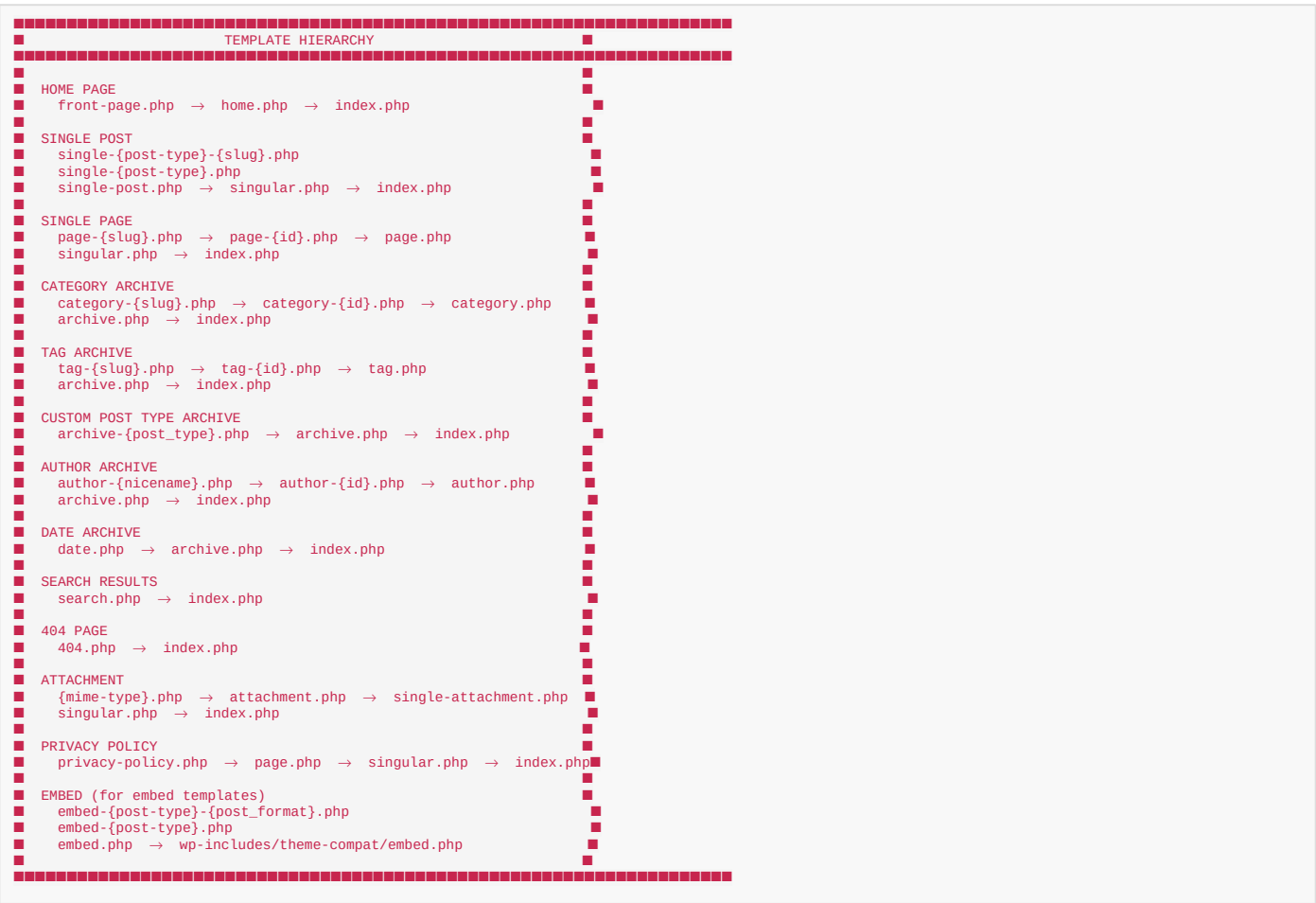
.my-class {
  color: var(--wp--preset--color--primary);
  font-family: var(--wp--preset--font-family--inter);
  font-size: var(--wp--preset--font-size--large);
}

```

7. Template Hierarchy

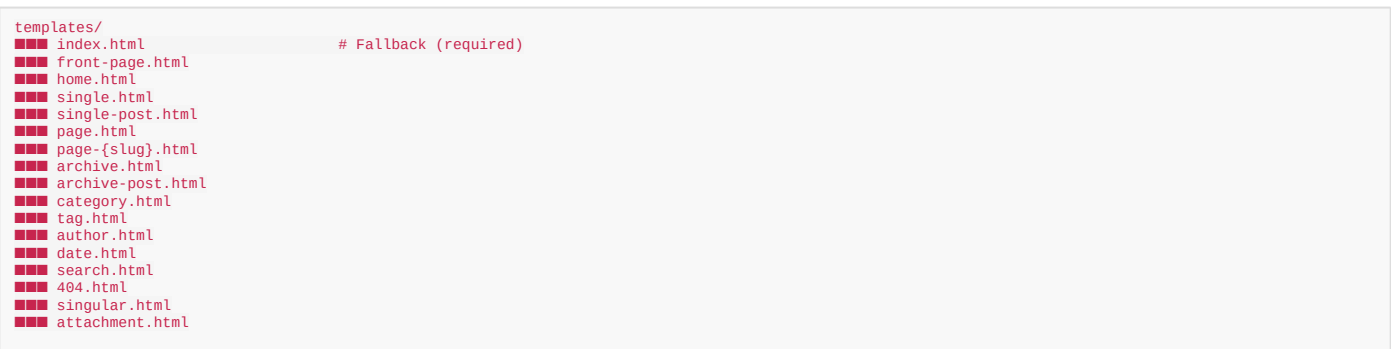
7.1 Classic Theme (PHP) Template Hierarchy

WordPress traverses this hierarchy top-to-bottom, using the first matching file.



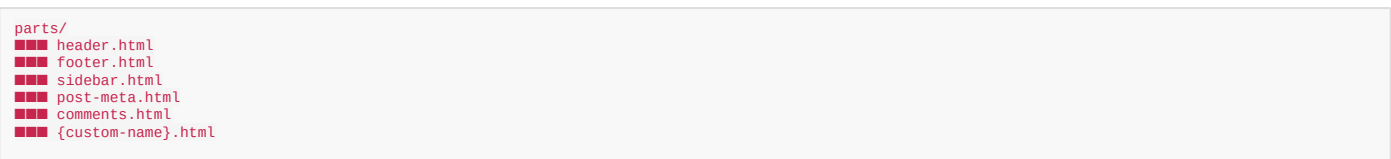
7.2 Block Theme (HTML) Template Hierarchy

Same hierarchy, but file extensions are `.html`. The `templates/` directory is checked:



If files don't exist in `templates/`, WordPress also checks `block-templates/` (deprecated in favor of `templates/`).

7.3 Template Parts Hierarchy



Template parts are referenced via `<!-- wp:template-part {"slug":"header"} /-->` in block templates.

7.4 Conditional Tags (Used in classic themes)

```

<?php if ( is_front_page() && is_home() ) :      // Default homepage ?>
<?php elseif ( is_front_page() ) :              // Static front page ?>
<?php elseif ( is_home() ) :                    // Blog posts index ?>
<?php elseif ( is_single() ) :                  // Single post ?>
<?php elseif ( is_page() ) :                    // Single page ?>
<?php elseif ( is_page_template( 'full-width.php' ) ) : ?>
<?php elseif ( is_category() ) :                // Category archive ?>
<?php elseif ( is_tag() ) :                     // Tag archive ?>
<?php elseif ( is_author() ) :                  // Author archive ?>
<?php elseif ( is_date() ) :                    // Date archive ?>
<?php elseif ( is_archive() ) :                 // Any archive ?>
<?php elseif ( is_search() ) :                  // Search results ?>
<?php elseif ( is_404() ) :                     // 404 page ?>
<?php elseif ( is_attachment() ) :              // Attachment page ?>
<?php elseif ( is_singular() ) :                // Any singular post ?>
<?php elseif ( is_post_type_archive( 'product' ) ) : ?>
<?php endif; ?>

```

8. Divi 5 Child Theme Development

8.1 Divi 5 Architecture Changes

Divi 5 is a complete rewrite with: - **React-based Visual Builder** — faster, modern JS architecture - **Complete Site Editing** (Divi 5.1+) — edit headers, footers, body layouts, and page content in one step - **Theme Builder 2.0** — editable theme builder areas - **Composable Settings** (upcoming) — enable any design setting on any module sub-element - **Public API** — new APIs for module development

8.2 Divi 5 Child Theme Structure

```

divi-5-child/
├── style.css           # Required – child theme header
├── functions.php       # PHP overrides
├── theme.json          # Optional – block editor styling
├── assets/
│   ├── css/
│   │   ├── custom.css
│   │   └── js/
│   │       ├── custom.js
│   └── et-custom/     # Divi-specific overrides

```

8.3 style.css

```

/*
Theme Name: Divi 5 Child
Theme URI: https://example.com/divi-5-child
Description: Child theme for Divi 5
Author: Your Name
Author URI: https://example.com
Template: Divi
Version: 1.0.0
License: GNU General Public License v2 or later
License URI: https://www.gnu.org/licenses/gpl-2.0.html
Text Domain: divi-5-child
*/

```

Critical: `Template: Divi` must match the parent theme's directory name exactly (case-sensitive).

8.4 functions.php — Enqueue Parent & Child Styles

```

<?php
/**
 * Divi 5 Child Theme Functions
 */

// Enqueue parent and child styles
function divi_5_child_enqueue_styles() {
    // Enqueue parent theme stylesheet
    wp_enqueue_style(
        'divi-parent-style',
        get_template_directory_uri() . '/style.css',
        array(),
        wp_get_theme( 'Divi' )->get( 'Version' )
    );

    // Enqueue child theme stylesheet
    wp_enqueue_style(
        'divi-child-style',
        get_stylesheet_uri(),
        array( 'divi-parent-style' ),
        wp_get_theme()->get( 'Version' )
    );
}
add_action( 'wp_enqueue_scripts', 'divi_5_child_enqueue_styles' );

```

8.5 Divi 5 PHP Module Override (Custom Module)

```

<?php
/**
 * Register custom Divi 5 module
 */

function divi_5_child_register_modules() {
    if ( class_exists( 'ET_Builder_Module' ) ) {
        class ET_Builder_Module_Custom_Card extends ET_Builder_Module {
            public $slug = 'et_pb_custom_card';
            public $vb_support = 'on';

            public function init() {
                $this->name = esc_html__( 'Custom Card', 'divi-5-child' );
            }
        }
    }
}

```

```

        $this->icon = '■';

        $this->settings_modal_toggles = array(
            'general' => array(
                'toggles' => array(
                    'main_content' => esc_html__( 'Content', 'divi-5-child' ),
                    'image' => esc_html__( 'Image', 'divi-5-child' ),
                ),
            ),
            'advanced' => array(
                'toggles' => array(
                    'card_styles' => esc_html__( 'Card Styles', 'divi-5-child' ),
                ),
            ),
        );
    }

    public function get_fields() {
        return array(
            'title' => array(
                'label' => esc_html__( 'Card Title', 'divi-5-child' ),
                'type' => 'text',
                'option_category' => 'basic_option',
                'toggle_slug' => 'main_content',
            ),
            'content' => array(
                'label' => esc_html__( 'Description', 'divi-5-child' ),
                'type' => 'tiny_mce',
                'option_category' => 'basic_option',
                'toggle_slug' => 'main_content',
            ),
            'card_image' => array(
                'label' => esc_html__( 'Card Image', 'divi-5-child' ),
                'type' => 'upload',
                'option_category' => 'basic_option',
                'upload_button_text' => esc_attr__( 'Upload Image', 'divi-5-child' ),
                'choose_text' => esc_attr__( 'Choose Image', 'divi-5-child' ),
                'update_text' => esc_attr__( 'Set As Image', 'divi-5-child' ),
                'toggle_slug' => 'image',
            ),
        );
    }

    public function render( $attrs, $content = null, $render_slug ) {
        $title = $this->props['title'];
        $content = $this->props['content'];
        $card_image = $this->props['card_image'];

        $output = '<div class="custom-card">';
        if ( $card_image ) {
            $output .= '<div class="custom-card__image"></div>';
        }
        if ( $title ) {
            $output .= '<h3 class="custom-card__title">' . esc_html( $title ) . '</h3>';
        }
        if ( $content ) {
            $output .= '<div class="custom-card__content">' . et_core_sanitized_previously( $content ) . '</div>';
        }
        $output .= '</div>';

        return $output;
    }
}

new ET_Builder_Module_Custom_Card();
}
}
add_action( 'et_builder_ready', 'divi_5_child_register_modules' );

```

8.6 Divi 5 Theme Builder Custom Areas

In Divi 5.1+, you can create custom Theme Builder areas:

```

<?php
/**
 * Register custom theme builder areas for Divi 5
 */
function divi_5_child_register_theme_builder_areas( $areas ) {
    $areas['custom_before_header'] = array(
        'label' => esc_html__( 'Before Header', 'divi-5-child' ),
        'priority' => 5,
    );
    $areas['custom_after_footer'] = array(
        'label' => esc_html__( 'After Footer', 'divi-5-child' ),
        'priority' => 95,
    );
    return $areas;
}
add_filter( 'et_theme_builder_template_layouts', 'divi_5_child_register_theme_builder_areas' );

```

8.7 Divi 5 CSS Override Snippets

```

/* Override Divi 5 header */
.et_builder_inner_content .et_pb_section.et_pb_section_0 {
    background-color: #1a1a2e !important;
}

/* Custom button styles that survive Divi 5 updates */
.et_pb_button {
    border-radius: 50px !important;
    font-weight: 700 !important;
    letter-spacing: 0.5px !important;
    transition: all 0.3s ease !important;
}

.et_pb_button:hover {
    transform: translateY(-2px);
    box-shadow: 0 4px 12px rgba(0,0,0,0.2);
}

```

```

/* Custom Divi 5 mobile breakpoint overrides */
@media (max-width: 980px) {
  .et_pb_section {
    padding-top: 40px !important;
    padding-bottom: 40px !important;
  }
}

```

8.8 Divi 5 + theme.json Integration

Divi 5 child themes can include a `theme.json` file for block editor integration:

```

{
  "version": 2,
  "settings": {
    "color": {
      "palette": [
        { "slug": "divi-primary", "color": "#2b87da", "name": "Divi Blue" },
        { "slug": "divi-accent", "color": "#7cda24", "name": "Divi Green" }
      ]
    },
    "typography": {
      "fontFamilies": [
        {
          "fontFamily": "'Open Sans', Arial, sans-serif",
          "slug": "open-sans",
          "name": "Open Sans"
        }
      ]
    }
  }
}

```

9. Child Themes (Standard WordPress)

9.1 Minimal Child Theme

```

parent-sunrise/
├── style.css      # Contains: Theme Name, Template: parent-name
├── functions.php  # Optional: enqueue parent styles
└── theme.json     # Optional: override parent theme.json

```

9.2 style.css for Standard Child Theme

```

/*
Theme Name:      Grand Sunrise
Theme URI:       https://example.com/grand-sunrise
Description:     A child theme of Twenty Twenty-Five
Author:          Your Name
Author URI:      https://example.com
Template:        twentytwentyfive
Version:         1.0.0
License:         GNU General Public License v2 or later
License URI:     https://www.gnu.org/licenses/gpl-2.0.html
Text Domain:     grand-sunrise
*/

```

9.3 functions.php — Enqueue Parent Styles (Classic)

```

<?php
function grand_sunrise_enqueue_styles() {
    wp_enqueue_style(
        'parent-style',
        get_template_directory_uri() . '/style.css',
        array(),
        wp_get_theme()->parent()->get( 'Version' )
    );
    wp_enqueue_style(
        'child-style',
        get_stylesheet_uri(),
        array( 'parent-style' ),
        wp_get_theme()->get( 'Version' )
    );
}
add_action( 'wp_enqueue_scripts', 'grand_sunrise_enqueue_styles' );

```

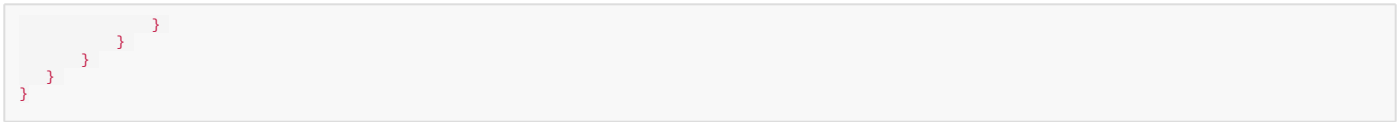
9.4 Block Theme Child — theme.json Override

Child theme.json is **merged** with parent theme.json (child values win):

```

{
  "version": 2,
  "styles": {
    "color": {
      "text": "#1a1a2e",
      "background": "#fafafa"
    },
    "elements": {
      "link": {
        "color": {
          "text": "#e94e77"
        }
      },
      "heading": {
        "color": {
          "text": "#16213e"
        }
      }
    }
  }
}

```



9.5 What Child Themes Can Override

Asset	How to Override
style.css	Child's <code>style.css</code> loads after parent
Templates	Place same-named file in child theme
Template parts	Place same-named file in child theme
theme.json	Merged — child values take precedence
Patterns	Same slug in child's <code>patterns/</code> overrides parent
functions.php	Child's <code>functions.php</code> runs AFTER parent
PHP template parts	<code>get_template_part()</code> checks child first
Assets (CSS/JS)	Enqueue from child theme directory

9.6 Override Priority (Lowest to Highest)

```
WordPress Defaults → Parent Theme → Child Theme → User Customizations (DB)
```

10. Theme Testing

10.1 Theme Unit Test Data

- 1. Download the [Theme Unit Test XML](#)
- 2. Go to **Tools > Import > WordPress** and install the WordPress Importer
- 3. Import the test data XML file
- 4. Verify: all post formats, long titles, no title, edge cases render correctly

10.2 WordPress Settings to Test

Setting	Test Configuration
General	Set Site Title to a very long string; set Tagline even longer
Reading	"Blog pages show at most" = 5 (triggers pagination)
Discussion	Enable threaded comments to 3+ levels; break into pages at 5 comments
Media	Remove large size dimensions; test <code>\$content_width</code>
Permalinks	Cycle through Plain, Day/Name, Post Name

10.3 Theme Check Plugin

```
# Install and run
wp plugin install theme-check --activate
```

Then go to **Appearance > Theme Check**, select your theme, and run. This is the same automated check WordPress.org uses.

10.4 Manual Testing Checklist

- ☐ **All post formats**: standard, aside, gallery, link, image, quote, status, video, audio, chat
- ☐ **Post with no title**
- ☐ **Post with extremely long title**
- ☐ **Comments**: threaded, paginated, no comments, closed comments
- ☐ **Password-protected posts**
- ☐ **Sticky posts**
- ☐ **Pagination**: posts, comments, archive pages
- ☐ **404 page**: nonexistent URLs
- ☐ **Search**: with and without results
- ☐ **Images**: aligned left/right/center/none, captioned, galleries
- ☐ **Embeds**: YouTube, Twitter, etc.
- ☐ **Responsive design**: desktop, tablet, mobile
- ☐ **Browser testing**: Chrome, Firefox, Safari, Edge
- ☐ **RTL languages**: test with WP RTL Tester
- ☐ **Block editor**: all core blocks render correctly
- ☐ **Customizer/Editor**: theme supports reflect correctly
- ☐ **Widget areas** (classic themes only)

10.5 Accessibility Testing

- Keyboard navigation through all interactive elements

- Screen reader testing (NVDA or VoiceOver)
- Color contrast ratios (WCAG AA minimum: 4.5:1 for normal text, 3:1 for large text)
- Focus indicators visible on all interactive elements
- `aria-label` on navigation and icon links
- Skip-to-content link present

10.6 Debug Mode for Development

Add to `wp-config.php`:

```
define( 'WP_DEBUG', true );
define( 'WP_DEBUG_LOG', true );
define( 'WP_DEBUG_DISPLAY', false );
define( 'SCRIPT_DEBUG', true );
```

10.7 Testing Against Beta/RC WordPress

```
# Using WP-CLI
wp core update --version=7.0-RC3

# Or use WordPress Beta Tester plugin
wp plugin install wordpress-beta-tester --activate
```

10.8 Performance Testing

```
# Check theme load with Query Monitor
wp plugin install query-monitor --activate
```

Key metrics: page load time, database queries, memory usage, asset sizes.

11. Theme Distribution & Release

11.1 Required Files for WordPress.org

File	Required?	Notes
<code>style.css</code>	Yes	Must have valid theme header
<code>templates/index.html</code> (block) or <code>index.php</code> (classic)	Yes	Fallback template
<code>screenshot.png</code>	No (but strongly recommended)	1200×900px
<code>README.txt</code>	Yes (for .org submission)	Theme documentation
<code>theme.json</code>	No (for block themes, strongly recommended)	
<code>functions.php</code>	No	

11.2 README.txt Format

```
=== My Theme Name ===
Contributors: yourusername
Requires at least: 6.6
Tested up to: 7.0
Requires PHP: 8.0
Stable tag: 1.0.0
License: GPLv2 or later
License URI: https://www.gnu.org/licenses/gpl-2.0.html

A short description of your theme.

== Description ==

A longer description of what your theme does, who it's for,
and what features it includes.

== Installation ==

1. Upload the theme folder to `/wp-content/themes/`
2. Activate through Appearance > Themes

== Frequently Asked Questions ==

= How do I customize colors? =

Use the Site Editor (Appearance > Editor) to customize
colors, typography, and layout.

== Changelog ==

= 1.0.0 =
* Initial release

== Credits ==

* Based on Twenty Twenty-Five
* Uses Inter font (SIL Open Font License)
```

11.3 Theme Review Guidelines (Key Points)

From <https://developer.wordpress.org/themes/releasing-your-theme/theme-review-guidelines/>:

- 1. **GPLv2+ Compatible** — theme must be GPL-compatible
- 2. **No plugin territory** — shortcodes, CPTs, custom blocks must be in plugins
- 3. **No admin panels that persist after theme switch** — use Customizer or Site Editor
- 4. **Prefix everything** — functions, classes, handles, slugs, options
- 5. **Escaping** — all output must be escaped: `esc_html()`, `esc_url()`, `esc_attr()`
- 6. **Translation-ready** — all strings use `__() / _e()` with text domain
- 7. **No hard-coded scripts/styles** — use `wp_enqueue_*`
- 8. **Privacy** — no phone-home, tracking without opt-in
- 9. **Theme Check plugin** must pass with 0 required warnings
- 10. **3+ distinct issues** → **auto-closed**

11.4 Submission Process

- 1. Ensure all [required files](#) are present
- 2. Run [Theme Check plugin](#)
- 3. Review the [guidelines](#)
- 4. Create a ZIP of your theme folder
- 5. Upload to <https://wordpress.org/themes/upload/>
- 6. Wait for review (may take days to weeks)
- 7. Address any reviewer feedback
- 8. Once approved, your theme appears in the directory

11.5 Updating Your Theme

```
# Bump version in style.css and README.txt
# Create a new ZIP
# Upload through your theme's admin page on .org
```

For version numbering, use [Semantic Versioning](#): `MAJOR.MINOR.PATCH`

11.6 Premium/Distribution Outside .org

- GPL still applies if you distribute the theme
- Consider using Freemius or EDD for licensing
- Provide auto-update mechanism
- Keep documentation separate from theme files

12. Quick Reference Cards

12.1 Block Theme Starter Files

```
# Create minimal block theme structure
mkdir -p my-theme/{templates,parts,patterns,styles,assets/{css,js,images}}
touch my-theme/{style.css,theme.json,functions.php,screenshot.png,README.txt}
touch my-theme/templates/index.html
touch my-theme/parts/{header.html,footer.html}
```

12.2 Common WordPress Functions for Themes

Function	Purpose
<code>get_header()</code>	Include header.php
<code>get_footer()</code>	Include footer.php
<code>get_sidebar()</code>	Include sidebar.php
<code>get_template_part(\$slug, \$name)</code>	Include partial template
<code>wp_head()</code>	WP head hooks (must be in <code><head></code>)
<code>wp_footer()</code>	WP footer hooks (must be before <code></body></code>)
<code>body_class()</code>	Output body CSS classes
<code>post_class()</code>	Output post CSS classes
<code>the_title()</code>	Output post title
<code>the_content()</code>	Output post content
<code>the_excerpt()</code>	Output post excerpt
<code>the_permalink()</code>	Output post URL
<code>the_post_thumbnail()</code>	Output featured image
<code>wp_nav_menu()</code>	Output navigation menu
<code>language_attributes()</code>	Output <code><html></code> lang attributes
<code>bloginfo('name')</code>	Site name

<code>bloginfo('charset')</code>	Character encoding
<code>home_url()</code>	Site home URL
<code>get_template_directory_uri()</code>	Parent theme URL
<code>get_stylesheet_directory_uri()</code>	Child theme URL
<code>esc_html()</code>	Escape HTML output
<code>esc_url()</code>	Escape URLs
<code>esc_attr()</code>	Escape HTML attributes

12.3 Block Theme Block Shortcuts

Block	Markup
Site Title	<code><!-- wp:site-title /--></code>
Site Logo	<code><!-- wp:site-logo /--></code>
Site Tagline	<code><!-- wp:site-tagline /--></code>
Navigation	<code><!-- wp:navigation {"ref":4} /--></code>
Post Title	<code><!-- wp:post-title /--></code>
Post Content	<code><!-- wp:post-content /--></code>
Post Date	<code><!-- wp:post-date /--></code>
Post Excerpt	<code><!-- wp:post-excerpt /--></code>
Post Featured Image	<code><!-- wp:post-featured-image /--></code>
Query Loop	<code><!-- wp:query -->...<!-- /wp:query --></code>
Post Template	<code><!-- wp:post-template -->...<!-- /wp:post-template --></code>
Template Part	<code><!-- wp:template-part {"slug":"header"} /--></code>
Login/out Link	<code><!-- wp:loginout /--></code>
Page List	<code><!-- wp:page-list /--></code>

12.4 Common WP-CLI Commands for Theme Dev

```
# Create a blank theme structure
wp scaffold _s my-theme --theme_name="My Theme"

# Create a block theme skeleton
wp scaffold block-theme my-block-theme --theme_name="My Block Theme"

# Create a child theme
wp scaffold child-theme my-child --parent_theme=twentytwentyfive --theme_name="My Child"

# Check theme requirements
wp theme check my-theme

# Export current theme
wp theme export my-theme --zip

# Test theme activation
wp theme activate my-theme

# Generate theme test data
wp post generate --count=10

# Check for PHP errors
wp eval "phpinfo();"
```

12.5 ESLint/Prettier Config for Theme JS

```
{
  "extends": [ "@wordpress/eslint-plugin/recommended" ],
  "env": {
    "browser": true,
    "jquery": true
  },
  "globals": {
    "wp": true,
    "et_fb": true,
    "Divi": true
  }
}
```

12.6 Theme PHPCS Configuration

```
# Install WordPress coding standards
composer require --dev wp-coding-standards/wpcs
./vendor/bin/phpcs --config-set installed_paths vendor/wp-coding-standards/wpcs

# Run the check
./vendor/bin/phpcs --standard=WordPress wp-content/themes/my-theme/
```

12.7 Build Script (package.json example)

```
{
  "name": "my-block-theme",
  "version": "1.0.0",
  "scripts": {
    "build": "wp-scripts build",
  }
}
```

```
    "start": "wp-scripts start",
    "lint:js": "wp-scripts lint-js",
    "lint:css": "wp-scripts lint-style",
    "format": "wp-scripts format",
    "check-engines": "wp-scripts check-engines",
    "zip": "wp-scripts plugin-zip"
  },
  "devDependencies": {
    "@wordpress/scripts": "^27.0.0"
  }
}
```

Appendix A: Quick Decision Tree

Starting a new theme project?

- Simple blog/portfolio? → Block theme (fastest to build, FSE)
- Complex custom functionality? → Classic theme or Hybrid
- Building on existing theme? → Child theme
- Using Divi builder? → Divi 5 child theme
- .org directory submission? → Follow Releasing guidelines (§11)
- Client project with future customization? → Block theme + theme.json

Appendix B: Version Compatibility

WordPress Version	theme.json Version	Block Themes	FSE
5.8	1 (experimental)	No	No
5.9	2	Yes	Yes
6.0	2	Yes	Yes
6.1–6.7	2	Yes	Yes
7.0	2	Yes	Yes

Appendix C: Key URLs Summary

Resource	URL
Theme Handbook	https://developer.wordpress.org/themes/
Global Settings & Styles	https://developer.wordpress.org/themes/global-settings-and-styles/
theme.json Schema	https://schemas.wp.org/trunk/theme.json
Template Hierarchy	https://developer.wordpress.org/themes/classic-themes/basics/template-hierarchy/
Child Themes	https://developer.wordpress.org/themes/advanced-topics/child-themes/
Theme Testing	https://developer.wordpress.org/themes/releasing-your-theme/testing/
Theme Review Guidelines	https://developer.wordpress.org/themes/releasing-your-theme/theme-review-guidelines/
Requirements	https://developer.wordpress.org/themes/releasing-your-theme/required-theme-files/
WP 7.0 Field Guide	https://make.wordpress.org/core/2026/05/14/wordpress-7-0-field-guide/
Block Editor: Themes	https://developer.wordpress.org/block-editor/how-to-guides/themes/
Divi 5.1 Release	https://www.elegantthemes.com/blog/divi-resources/divi-5-1-release-notes

This playbook covers WordPress 7.0 theme development end-to-end. For the latest updates, always check the official [Theme Handbook](#) and the [Make WordPress Core blog](#).